



World Cup
2010

Cover Story

South Africa UNITED

With shiny new infrastructure and beefed-up security, South Africa says *Wozani*, or come on in, and enjoy the vibe of the World Cup's coolest host



REUTERS

| By Lungani Zama |

After almost six years of waiting and worrying, the FIFA World Cup is finally here in South Africa. Next week's opening ceremony and the first game for 'Bafana Bafana'—the nickname given to the national side—will signal the beginning of what many in South Africa, and indeed Africa, hope to be the best World Cup ever.

It's been a long road, filled with doubt and fear, but the construction of wondrous stadiums across the country and the major overhaul of transport facilities convinced those who refused to believe that the world could trust Africa with such a massive responsibility.

Many are calling this an opportunity for not only South Africa, but also for the continent of Africa as a whole. Long seen as the poor cousin in the world, hosting the biggest sports event

SOUTH AFRICA'S FOOTBALL FANS ARE LIVELY AND ARE WAITING FOR THE WORLD TO ARRIVE

in the world illustrates just how far the 'dark continent' has come.

South Africa has embraced the Cup, with the majority of workplaces and even schools adopting 'Football Fridays', where employees ditch regular attire and wear 'Bafana Bafana' shirts to add to the excitement of the biggest year in South Africa's sporting history.